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Sardar Patel Institute of Technology (SPIT)
Academic Year 2026–27

Student Grievance Redressal Policy

Office of the Registrar (Student Grievance Redressal Cell)

Field	Details
Document ID	SPIT-CA-GRV-2026-01
Document Title	Student Grievance Redressal Policy
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Version	3.0
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Effective Date	1 July 2026
Supersedes	SPIT-CA-GRV-2023-02 (Student Grievance Redressal Policy, Version 2.0, effective 1 January 2024)
Applicable To	All students (UG, PG, PhD), applicants for admission, and former students in respect of grievances arising within one year of leaving the institute
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1. Purpose and Principles

1.1 This policy provides a fair, time-bound and transparent mechanism for students to raise grievances about academic and non-academic matters, and for the institute to resolve them.

1.2 The policy is based on the following principles:

- **Accessibility:** any student can file a grievance online, in person or by post, free of charge.
- **Time-bound resolution:** every grievance is acknowledged within 2 working days and decided within the timelines in Section 6.
- **Fairness:** the student is heard before a decision is taken, and no person decides a grievance in which he or she is personally involved.
- **Confidentiality:** the identity of the complainant and the details of the grievance are disclosed only to those who need to know them to resolve it.
- **No retaliation:** no student shall be penalised, victimised or disadvantaged for filing a grievance in good faith.

1.3 This version (3.0) replaces the Student Grievance Redressal Policy, Version 2.0 (SPIT-CA-GRV-2023-02). The principal changes are listed in Section 13.

2. Definitions

2.1 **Grievance** means a written complaint by an aggrieved student about any act, omission or decision of the institute, its officers, faculty or staff that the student considers unfair, or that violates the institute's rules, policies or the student's rights.

2.2 **Aggrieved student** means a student, an applicant for admission, or a former student (for grievances arising within one year of leaving) who has a grievance.

2.3 **Working day** means any day from Monday to Saturday except the second and fourth Saturdays, Sundays and public holidays declared by the institute. The same definition is used in the Code of Conduct and Disciplinary Rules (SPIT-CA-COC-2026-01).

2.4 **Grievance ticket** means the unique number (format GRV-2026-NNNNN) generated when a grievance is registered. All communication about a grievance uses this number.

3. Matters Covered and Excluded

3.1 The following are examples of matters that may be raised as grievances:

Area	Examples
Admission	Irregularity in the admission process, non-publication of prospectus information, retention of original certificates, denial of admission contrary to published criteria
Academic	Non-adherence to the published academic calendar or syllabus, unfair internal assessment process, delay in declaring internal marks, non-availability of a faculty mentor
Examinations (administrative)	Delay in issue of grade cards, transcripts or certificates; errors in personal details on certificates
Fees and finance	Demand of fees not notified in the fee structure, delay in fee refund, delay in scholarship disbursement by the institute
Hostel and mess	Facilities, maintenance, food quality, allotment process
Library and campus facilities	Library services, laboratories, classrooms, Wi-Fi, canteen, transport, sanitation, accessibility for students with disabilities
Student services	Delay in club reimbursements, harassment by staff, denial of a service the student is entitled to
Discrimination	Discrimination on the basis of caste, religion, gender, disability, region, language or economic status

3.2 The following are **not** dealt with under this policy, because separate procedures apply:

Matter	Where it is dealt with
Re-evaluation, re-totalling or verification of end-semester examination answer books	Procedure in the Examination Rules and Regulations
Disputes about grades and CGPA calculation rules	Grading and CGPA Policy and the examination procedure
Appeals against penalties imposed by the Disciplinary Committee	Appeal procedure in Section 10 of the Code of Conduct and Disciplinary Rules (SPIT-CA-COC-2026-01)
Complaints of sexual harassment	Internal Complaints Committee (ICC), see Section 9.1
Complaints of ragging	Anti-Ragging Committee and Anti-Ragging Squad, see Section 9.2
Matters pending before a court of law or a statutory tribunal	Not admissible while the matter is sub judice
Grievances relating to a policy decision of the Governing Body	May be sent as a representation to the Director, not as a grievance

3.3 If a grievance relates to an excluded matter, the Grievance Cell will inform the student within 2 working days and forward the grievance to the correct authority, with a copy to the student.

4. Redressal Bodies

4.1 **Grievance Cell (Level 1).** The Grievance Cell is the first point of registration and resolution. It consists of the Grievance Officer (an Assistant Registrar), supported by one nominated faculty member from each department (the Departmental Grievance Coordinator). The Grievance Officer assigns each grievance to the officer or department concerned and monitors resolution.

4.2 **Student Grievance Redressal Committee, SGRC (Level 2).** The SGRC hears grievances not resolved at Level 1, and grievances that the Grievance Officer refers directly because of their seriousness. Its composition for 2026–27 is:

Member	Role
A Professor nominated by the Director (not holding any administrative post)	Chairperson
Four senior faculty members from different departments, at least one of whom is a woman	Members
One faculty member from the Scheduled Castes or Scheduled Tribes	Member
The Grievance Officer	Member-Secretary (non-voting)
One student with an outstanding academic record, nominated by the Director from the top 10% of the final-year class	Special invitee (non-voting)

4.3 The quorum for an SGRC meeting is three members including the Chairperson. The term of SGRC members is two years.

4.4 **Ombudsperson (Level 3).** A student who is not satisfied with the SGRC's decision may appeal to the Ombudsperson for students appointed in accordance with the applicable regulations of the affiliating university and the University Grants Commission. The Ombudsperson for 2026–27 holds sittings on the campus on the first Saturday of every month, or online on request.

5. How to File a Grievance

5.1 **Before filing.** A student is encouraged, but not required, to first raise the issue informally with the concerned office (for example, the class teacher, the Librarian, the Warden, the Accounts Section). Most issues of routine service are resolved quickly this way.

5.2 **Modes of filing.** A grievance may be filed:

- online through the Student Grievance Portal (grievance.spit.example), using institute login credentials (preferred);
- in person at the Grievance Cell, Room A-110, Administrative Block, between 10:00 and 17:00 on working days, using Form G-1;
- by post or e-mail to grievance@spit.example, using Form G-1, for applicants and former students who do not have portal access.

5.3 **Contents.** A grievance must state the student's name, roll number or application number, contact details, the facts of the grievance, the date on which the cause of grievance arose, the relief sought, and copies of any supporting documents. A grievance may be written in English, Hindi or Marathi.

5.4 **Time limit.** A grievance must be filed within **30 days** of the date on which the cause of grievance arose. The Grievance Officer may accept a grievance filed up to **60 days** after that date if the student shows sufficient reason for the delay.

5.5 **Acknowledgement.** The student receives an acknowledgement with the grievance ticket number on the portal and by e-mail within **2 working days** of filing.

5.6 **Group grievances.** A grievance affecting a group of students (for example, an entire class) may be filed by up to five representatives on behalf of the group, with a list of the students supporting it.

6. Resolution Procedure and Timelines

6.1 The table below sets out the levels, who decides, and the maximum time allowed.

Level	Body	Time to decide	Time for the student to escalate
Registration	Grievance Cell	Acknowledgement within 2 working days	–
Level 1	Grievance Officer with the officer or department concerned	10 working days from registration	Within 10 working days of the Level 1 decision, or automatically if no decision is given
Level 2	Student Grievance Redressal Committee (SGRC)	15 working days from receipt of the escalation	Within 15 working days of the SGRC decision
Level 3	Ombudsperson	30 days from receipt of the appeal	Decision of the Ombudsperson is final within the institute

6.2 **Level 1.** The Grievance Officer forwards the grievance to the officer or department concerned, which must submit a response and the action taken within 5 working days. The Grievance Officer communicates the decision to the student through the portal within 10 working days of registration.

6.3 **Automatic escalation.** If no decision is communicated at Level 1 within 10 working days, the grievance is automatically escalated to the SGRC by the portal, and the student is informed.

6.4 **Direct referral.** The Grievance Officer refers the following grievances directly to the SGRC without a Level 1 decision: grievances alleging discrimination; grievances against a Head of Department or an officer of the rank of Dean or above; and group grievances involving more than 30 students.

6.5 **Level 2 hearing.** The SGRC gives the student and the person or office complained against an opportunity to be heard, in person or online, with at least 3 working days' notice. The student may be accompanied by a parent, guardian or fellow student but may not be represented by a lawyer. The SGRC may call for records and witnesses. It records its decision with reasons and communicates it within 15 working days.

6.6 **Level 3 appeal.** An appeal to the Ombudsperson is filed through the portal or by e-mail to ombudsperson@spit.example, with a copy of the SGRC decision. The institute implements the Ombudsperson's recommendations within 30 days of receiving them, or records reasons for any non-implementation and reports them to the Governing Body.

6.7 **Interim relief.** Where delay would cause irreparable harm to the student (for example, a pending deadline for submission of documents to another university, or retention of original certificates), the Chairperson of the SGRC may grant interim relief within 3 working days.

6.8 **Closure.** A grievance is closed when (a) the student accepts the decision on the portal, (b) the time for escalation expires without an escalation, or (c) the student withdraws it. The student receives a closure notice and is invited to give feedback on the handling of the grievance.

7. Confidentiality and Protection from Retaliation

7.1 Information about a grievance is shared only with members of the redressal body handling it and with persons whose response is required. Grievance records are retained for five years.

7.2 No student may be victimised for filing a grievance in good faith or for being a witness. Any act of retaliation by a student is a Category B offence under the Code of Conduct and Disciplinary Rules (SPIT-CA-COC-2026-01); retaliation by faculty or staff is referred to the Director for action under the

service rules.

7.3 A grievance found by the SGRC to be deliberately false or filed with malicious intent may be referred to the Dean of Student Affairs for action under the Code of Conduct and Disciplinary Rules. A grievance that is not upheld is not, by itself, considered false or malicious.

8. Anonymous Safe Reports

8.1 Grievances under this policy must normally be filed in the student's name so that the student can be heard and informed of the outcome.

8.2 For reports of **ragging, harassment, bullying, substance abuse on campus or safety hazards**, a student may submit an anonymous "Safe Report" through the portal. A Safe Report is not a grievance; it is used to trigger a preliminary inquiry by the Dean of Student Affairs or the relevant committee. The reporter receives a tracking code to check whether action has been initiated, but individual outcomes are not disclosed.

9. Special Committees and Cells

9.1 **Internal Complaints Committee (ICC).** Complaints of sexual harassment are dealt with by the ICC under the applicable law and the institute's Policy on Prevention of Sexual Harassment. A complaint should be made within three months of the incident (extendable by a further three months for reasons recorded in writing) to icc@spit.example or to any ICC member.

9.2 **Anti-Ragging Committee and Squad.** Complaints of ragging may be made to any member of the Anti-Ragging Committee or Squad, to the Warden, to the Dean of Student Affairs, through a Safe Report, or through the national anti-ragging helpline. The procedure is set out in Section 6 of the Code of Conduct and Disciplinary Rules (SPIT-CA-COC-2026-01).

9.3 **Equal Opportunity Cell and SC/ST Cell.** Grievances alleging discrimination may also be submitted directly to the Equal Opportunity Cell (eoc@spit.example) or the SC/ST Cell (scstcell@spit.example). These cells forward the grievance to the SGRC and provide support to the student during the process.

9.4 **Students with disabilities.** Grievances about accessibility or reasonable accommodation are referred to the SGRC with the Disability Support Coordinator as a special invitee.

10. Grievances About Specific Services

10.1 The following first-contact points apply before or alongside a formal grievance. If the issue is not resolved within the period stated, the student may file a formal grievance.

Service	First contact	Period for informal resolution
Library services and fines	Librarian (Library Rules and Regulations, SPIT-CA-LIB-2026-01)	7 working days
Hostel facilities, mess, allotment	Block Warden, then Chief Warden (Hostel Rules and Regulations, SPIT-CA-HST-2026-01)	7 working days
Club approvals and reimbursements	Student Activities Cell (Student Clubs and Societies Handbook, SPIT-CA-CLB-2026-01)	7 working days
Fee payment, receipts, refunds	Accounts Section	10 working days
Certificates and administrative documents	Student Section, Administrative Block	7 working days

11. Monitoring and Reporting

11.1 The Grievance Officer maintains a register of all grievances on the portal, showing the date of filing, category, level, decision and date of closure.

11.2 The SGRC submits a quarterly summary to the Director and an annual report to the Governing Body, including the number of grievances received, resolved and pending by category, the average time to resolution, and any systemic issues identified with recommended corrective actions.

11.3 A summary of the annual report (without names or identifying details) is published on the institute website and the Student Portal by 31 August each year.

11.4 Awareness of this policy is created through the student induction programme, the Student Portal, notice boards and at least one awareness session per semester conducted by the Grievance Cell.

12. Responsibilities of Students

12.1 Students filing grievances must give truthful information, cooperate with the redressal bodies, attend hearings when called, and maintain the confidentiality of proceedings. Students must not post details of a pending grievance that identify other individuals on social media.

13. Changes from the Previous Version

13.1 This version (3.0) supersedes SPIT-CA-GRV-2023-02 (Version 2.0). The principal changes are:

Provision	Previous version 2.0 (2024)	This version 3.0 (2026–27)
Levels of redressal	Two levels: SGRC and Director	Three levels: Grievance Cell, SGRC, Ombudsperson
Time limit for filing a grievance	15 days from the cause	30 days, condonable up to 60 days
Acknowledgement	Within 7 working days	Within 2 working days, with ticket number
SGRC decision time	30 working days	15 working days
Filing method	Paper form only	Online portal (preferred), in person, by post or e-mail
Automatic escalation	Not available	Automatic escalation to SGRC if Level 1 is not decided within 10 working days
Anonymous reporting	Not permitted	"Safe Report" permitted for ragging, harassment, substance abuse and safety hazards
Student special invitee on SGRC	Not provided	One meritorious student as non-voting special invitee
Interim relief	Not provided	SGRC Chairperson may grant interim relief within 3 working days
Publication of annual report summary	Not required	Published by 31 August each year

13.2 Grievances filed before 1 July 2026 and still pending on that date continue under the previous procedure, but must be decided within 30 working days from 1 July 2026.

14. Contact

Purpose	Contact
Student Grievance Portal	grievance.spit.example
Grievance Cell (Grievance Officer)	Room A-110, Administrative Block; grievance@spit.example; extension 2110
Chairperson, SGRC	sgrc.chair@spit.example
Ombudsperson	ombudsperson@spit.example
Internal Complaints Committee	icc@spit.example; extension 2115
Dean of Student Affairs	Room A-102, Administrative Block; dsa@spit.example; extension 2100